

PRODUCT TEARDOWN

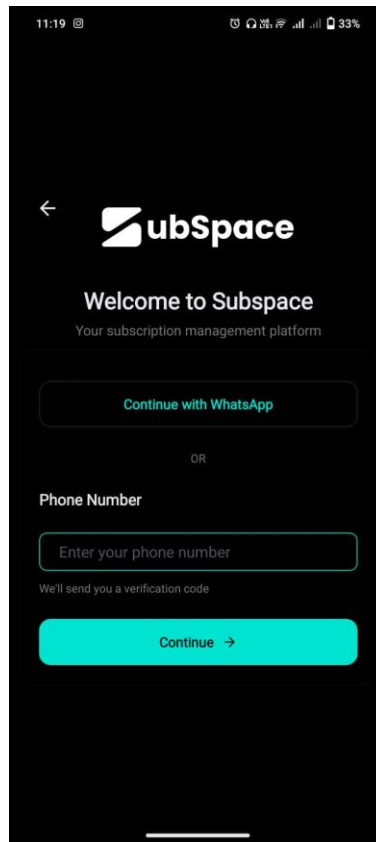
Subspace.money

Product Management Intern Assignment · May 2026

About This Report

This teardown presents 5 sharp, research-backed product feedbacks across all five evaluation pillars GTM & ICPs, Competitor Analysis, Features/Services, UX, and Potential Collaborations. Each feedback follows the required Observed → Problem → Ship Instead structure, grounded in real app usage and market data.

Prioritisation logic is included at the end using an Impact vs. Effort framework.



5 Feedbacks at a Glance

#	Pillar	Insight
1	Competitor Analysis	OTT crackdown creates unhedged business risk
2	GTM & ICPs	Group splitting has a cold-start problem
3	Features / Services	Auto-detection is a black box no transparency
4	Potential Collaborations	PhonePe mini-app is untapped distribution goldmine
5	UX	Home screen is cluttered no clear first action

Feedback #1 [Competitor Analysis]

OTT Account Sharing Crackdown Creates an Unhedged Business Risk

(a) Observed

On the Google Play Store, Subspace has user reviews explicitly stating: 'I took a subscription to Amazon Prime now the original subscriber logged me out and Subspace won't refund me.' The app's core value proposition up to 80% off on Netflix, Prime, Hotstar, YouTube Premium via shared accounts depends entirely on OTT platforms tolerating multi-user account sharing. There is no mention anywhere on the app or website of what happens when a shared login stops working.

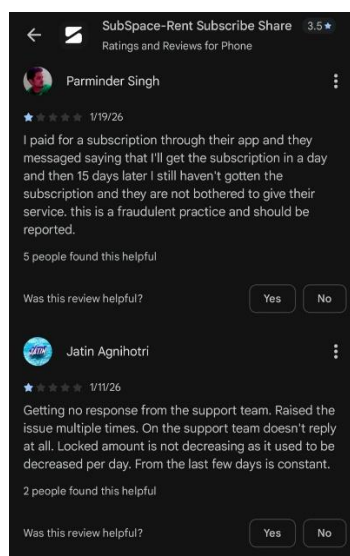
(b) Problem

Netflix already cracked down on password sharing globally in 2023–24. Disney+ Hotstar and Amazon Prime are tightening device/profile limits in India. Subspace's highest-margin, most-marketed feature sits on a foundation that its competitors the OTT platforms themselves are actively dismantling. This creates two compounding problems:

- User trust erosion paying customers lose access with no recourse, generating negative reviews and churn
- Business model fragility if 2-3 major OTT platforms enforce stricter sharing policies simultaneously, Subspace's subscription revenue takes a structural hit with no backup plan visible

(c) Ship Instead

- Introduce a 'Sharing Guarantee' if a shared login breaks within the subscription period, Subspace auto-credits the user's wallet within 24 hours. Protects trust at scale
- Pivot the framing from 'shared accounts' to 'group plans' officially supported family/group plans from OTTs are platform-sanctioned. Migrate inventory toward these and market the shift as a reliability upgrade
- Add a 'Hosted on official group plan' badge on safe listings builds trust and differentiates from grey-area listings



Feedback #2 [GTM & ICPs]

Group Splitting Feature Has a Cold-Start Problem Nobody Talks About

(a) Observed

When you open the Groups / bill-splitting section on Subspace, you're prompted to invite friends to split costs. But there's no pre-existing network no contacts already on Subspace, no nudge showing 'X of your contacts already use this,' no frictionless way to onboard a friend in under 30 seconds. Compare this to Splitwise, where every transaction is a forced acquisition moment the recipient has to download the app to settle. Subspace has no equivalent viral loop built into splitting.

(b) Problem

The ICP for group splitting is young urban Indians sharing rent, OTT costs, or trip expenses exactly the same people Splitwise already owns. Subspace is asking this user to abandon an app their entire friend group already uses, for a splitting feature that's secondary to Subspace's core subscription product. The GTM message is also unclear Subspace markets itself as a subscription savings app, so new users don't even know splitting exists until they're already inside the app.

(c) Ship Instead

- Make splitting the acquisition hook launch a standalone 'Split with Subspace' shareable link that works even for non-users. The recipient sees the expense, downloads to settle instant acquisition
- Target flatmate clusters specifically 'Split your Netflix, Hotstar & rent all in one place' is a message Splitwise literally cannot match since they don't do subscriptions
- Add a contacts-based social proof nudge on onboarding '3 of your contacts already save with Subspace' reduces cold-start anxiety

Feedback #3 [Features / Services]

Auto-Detection is the Hero Feature But It's a Black Box

(a) Observed

Subspace markets its auto-detection as a platform that 'automatically identifies and categorizes payments, subscriptions, and hidden costs simply log in, and we'll take care of the rest.' However, when you use the app, there's no transparency into how this works no explanation of which accounts it's reading, what permissions it needs, whether it missed anything, or why a particular subscription was or wasn't detected. There's no 'did we miss anything?' message, no confidence score, and no audit trail.

(b) Problem

Auto-detection is Subspace's biggest value hook it's the reason a user downloads the app. But a feature that works silently and invisibly creates two serious problems:

- Trust gap users don't know if detection is complete. If it misses 2 of your 8 subscriptions, you think you're covered but you're not
- Missed upsell opportunity every undetected subscription is a missed chance for Subspace to surface the Negotiate API. The moat becomes useless if detection is incomplete

(c) Ship Instead

- Add a 'Subscription Audit' screen post-onboarding show users a checklist: 'We found 5 subscriptions. Did we miss any?' with a tap-to-add flow for common ones
 - Show detection source transparency a small label: 'Detected via UPI · Last charged 12 May' builds trust and makes the magic feel reliable
 - Add a 'Savings Opportunity' flag on unoptimized subscriptions if Subspace detects full-price Netflix, immediately surface: 'Get this for 75% less via our marketplace → Save ₹450/month'
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Feedback #4 [Potential Collaborations]

Subspace is Sitting on a Distribution Goldmine It Hasn't Tapped

(a) Observed

Subspace's features currently require users to download a standalone app. But the actual payment data Subspace needs already lives inside UPI apps every recurring subscription charge, every auto-debit flows through PhonePe or GPay first. PhonePe alone processed 8.68 billion transactions in May 2025, commanding nearly 47% of all UPI volume in India. Yet there is zero integration between Subspace and India's dominant payment rails no PhonePe mini-app, no GPay plugin, no 'track this subscription' message after a recurring UPI debit.

(b) Problem

Subspace's biggest acquisition challenge is convincing users to download yet another app to track money they're already tracking elsewhere. Over 72% of new fintech product launches in India now involve at least one institutional partner (RBI Fintech Outlook 2026). Subspace is building its own distribution from scratch instead of riding rails that already reach 600 million Indians. Every time PhonePe processes a recurring Netflix charge that's a perfect moment for Subspace to appear with 'Get this for ₹149 instead of ₹649.' That moment currently goes to nobody.

(c) Ship Instead

- PhonePe Mini App a Subspace mini-app surfaced after every recurring UPI debit would give Subspace zero-CAC distribution at massive scale. The integration ask is a single post-payment nudge card with one CTA
 - Account Aggregator tie-up with ICICI/HDFC RBI's 2025 guidelines make bank-fintech API integration easier than ever. Use AA framework to pull subscription data directly from bank statements for complete detection
 - Corporate HR platform partnership with Darwinbox or Razorpay Payroll pitch Subspace as an employee benefit. 'Help your team save ₹3,000/month on subscriptions.' Zero B2C CAC, high-intent users
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Feedback #5 [UX]

The Home Screen Tries to Do Everything and Communicates Nothing

(a) Observed

When you land on Subspace's home screen, you're immediately hit with multiple competing sections subscription deals, gift cards, rentals, group sharing, expense tracking, marketplace listings, and promotional banners all visible above the fold or within the first scroll. There is no clear visual hierarchy guiding the eye. A first-time user cannot immediately answer: 'What is the one thing I should do right now?' Subspace's actual moats the Negotiate API and auto-detection are buried underneath promotional gift card banners that look identical to any generic deals app.

(b) Problem

This is a classic feature-dumping UX anti-pattern every team ships their feature onto the home screen and nobody owns the full user journey. Three compounding problems:

- New user confusion a user who downloaded Subspace to save on Netflix lands on a screen that looks like a mashup of Meesho, CashKaro, and Splitwise. They don't know where to start, so many don't
- Core value dilution Subspace's strongest hook is 'we save you money on subscriptions automatically.' That message gets lost when gift cards and rentals compete for the same visual real estate
- Retention drop-off users who don't find value in the first 90 seconds rarely return. A cluttered home screen makes that critical first moment harder to win

(c) Ship Instead

- Personalized home screen based on onboarding intent ask one question: 'What brought you to Subspace? Save on subscriptions / Split bills / Rent something.' Build the home screen around that job-to-be-done
- One dominant CTA 'You're spending ₹2,400/month on subscriptions. Save up to ₹1,800'. Everything else moves to a bottom nav tab. This mirrors how Zepto and Swiggy handle multi-category apps
- Sticky 'Your Savings Dashboard' as the top card show a running total: 'You've saved ₹3,200 this month with Subspace.' Creates an emotional anchor and reinforces the core brand promise every time the app is opened



Prioritisation Framework

Using an Impact vs. Effort matrix to determine shipping order:

#	Feedback	Impact	Effort	Priority
4	PhonePe Collaboration	Very High	Medium	P1 — Ship First
3	Auto-Detection Transparency	Very High	Low	P1 — Ship First
5	Home Screen UX	High	Low	P2 — Quick Win
1	OTT Crackdown Risk	Very High	High	P2 — Strategic
2	Cold-Start / GTM	High	Medium	P3 — After P1

Prioritisation Rationale

Feedbacks #3 and #4 ship first. #3 is low-effort and directly activates the Negotiate API revenue loop the core moat. #4 solves CAC at scale with one partnership, removing the single biggest growth constraint. #5 is a quick design sprint with outsized Day-1 retention impact. #1 is highest urgency long-term but requires strategic business model decisions before execution. #2 is important but depends on #4 succeeding first distribution before virality.
